

Live SERP Cross-Check

A second pass over the UK Physical-Product Niche Research pack (6 August 2026) · Every verdict evidenced from live Google UK page-1 results plus Ahrefs GB keyword data · Companion spreadsheet: [Partner-Crosscheck-ukphysicalproductniche.xlsx](#)

The short version

The pack's core idea is right and we are adopting it: supplier defensibility as a hard gate, written terms before inventory, and the Access Ropes lesson baked into scoring. What the pack was missing is live page-1 evidence. Its competition-gap scores were desk judgements, and on live checking they turn out to have been optimistic in nine cases out of ten. Applied to live Google UK results, **the pack's own supplier hard-stop rejects all four priority lanes**, because the manufacturers it hoped to buy from are already selling direct on page 1. One idea survives, and it was ranked tenth: **building diagnostic kits**. The freediving no-go is confirmed exactly as written.

We also filled in the Keyword Validation tab with real Ahrefs GB volumes (the pack correctly refused to fabricate them), and ran the pack's supplier gate back over our own current shortlist, which changed two of our three verdicts to conditional. Both changes are in the companion spreadsheet. The two methods work; they just need each other.

Combined verdict for both work streams

Merged screen: the pack's supplier gate and unit-economics thresholds, plus live page-1 shelf checks and the mis-served-search test. Combined shortlist as of today: 1) fire pit replacement bowls (passes both), 2) building diagnostic kits (the pack's survivor), 3) natural swimming pond kits and 4) garden putting green kits, both conditional on written supplier terms per the pack's rules.

How we checked

Two or three natural buyer searches per idea against live Google UK (SERPAPI, August 2026), page 1 read for three things: dedicated retail density (3-4+ options for the exact product means a pricing battle), manufacturers selling direct (the pack's own hard stop), and substitution (Google serving services, forums or the wrong product because nobody sells the searched-for thing, which is the one reliable sign of an open niche). Nineteen searches across the ten ideas, plus one idea (golf simulators) already checked in our earlier rounds. Keyword volumes are Ahrefs GB, 12-month averages.

Idea-by-idea verdicts

Idea	Pack decision	Live verdict and evidence
Rainwater & drought-resilience systems	Priority 1 (score 83)	OCCUPIED + CHANNEL CONFLICT. rainwaterharvesting.co.uk, a manufacturer selling packaged domestic systems, holds position 1. Five further specialists with transactional pages: Owls Hall, Tanks Direct (£187-£4,291), Rainharvesting Systems, Celtic Sustainables, Direct Water Tanks, Sumps & Pumps. Basket demand is real (1,960/mo core terms) and already served by the channel the pack hoped to join.
Performance acoustic room kits	Priority 2 (81.6)	OCCUPIED + SEVERE CONFLICT. 'Room kit' is a named product category at GIK Acoustics (position 1 on both queries), Primacoustic, Skum, Andertons, Gear4music, Advanced Acoustics and GB Foam, spanning £57 to £1,300. The category is defined by manufacturers selling direct, so a reseller competes with its own suppliers everywhere. Also: 'acoustic room kit' itself has zero measured search volume; the demand lives in 'acoustic panels' (25,000/mo, £0.87 CPC), which is a commodity term.
Sensory-room packages	Priority 3 (79.6)	OCCUPIED. Assumed quote-led; live page 1 is a transactional retail SERP with carted packages to £10,617: Sensory Direct (1.8k reviews), TTS, SpaceKraft, Rhino UK, Sensory Education, Experia (manufacturer, direct), TFH (manufacturer-retailer, £5,427 package), Sensory Toy Warehouse, Sense Sensory, SenTeq. Eight to ten dedicated options.
Separating & composting toilets	Priority 4 (78.8)	OCCUPIED + STRUCTURAL CONFLICT. Five brands sell direct on page 1 (TROBOLO, Trelino, BOXIO, CompoCloset, NatSol), including the exact brands a reseller would need to stock; CompoCloset holds position 1 on the campervan query with its own collection. WooWoo is the incumbent multi-brand retailer at position 1 on the head term.
Pond-health & filtration systems	Supplier DD (75.8)	OCCUPIED + CONFLICT. Six to seven pond and koi specialists plus Amazon: All Pond Solutions (two organic slots plus its own Amazon store), Bradshaws, Absolute Koi, World of Water, Swell, Pondkeeper. Evolution Aqua, the premium koi filtration manufacturer in exactly the proposed £850-£3k bundle territory, ranks selling direct.
Microcement installer systems	Supplier DD (72.5)	OCCUPIED + SEVERE CONFLICT. Eight-plus specialists and system brands. The 'restricted to trained installers' premise does not hold: Smartcret, Topciment, Festfloor, Epodex (from £79.99) and CARRcrete all sell kits openly and direct on page 1. Demand is large (microcement 7,000/mo, microcement bathroom 4,300/mo) and already channelled.
Golf simulator components & rooms	Supplier DD (71.3)	OCCUPIED (from our earlier round-5 check). Six-plus UK specialists; GolfBays' SimBox is stocked by four retailers on page 1; the Carl's Place import window closed two or three years ago. The pack's note about conflict with the golf client also stands.
Cold-plunge & contrast therapy	Watchlist (66.5)	OCCUPIED + STRUCTURAL CONFLICT. The category is now brand-direct D2C: MyoMaster, LUMI, Polar Recovery, Brass Monkey, Kirami all manufacture and sell direct, alongside spa retailers and Amazon, £189 to £15,750. 'Cold plunge' carries keyword difficulty 55, the hardest we have measured anywhere in this project. The pack's fad-risk caution was right.
Premium freediving equipment	No-go	NO-GO CONFIRMED. Five dedicated specialists holding seven organic slots (Spearfishing UK and Fins4U hold two each, the signature of an entrenched SERP) plus Decathlon, Amazon and eBay. Carbon fins £125-£270. The pack called this correctly before any search was run.

The survivor: building diagnostic kits

Ranked tenth in the pack at 70.3, and the only idea where live results show a genuine gap rather than a shelf.

What the live SERPs show

Component-level retail is occupied: four dealers (One Point Survey, PAM Ties, Toner Damp Proofing, York Survey) sell damp meters. But nobody owns the curated bundle intent the pack proposed (£1k-£3.5k camera + moisture meter + borescope + case + report templates + training), and the thermal-imaging query is answered entirely by survey services, RICS guidance, an NHBC PDF and forums. Google is serving 'get a survey done' to a buyer who wants to buy the kit. That substitution pattern is the same signature that preceded golfweights, and it is the only place in this pack where it appears.

Why the channel looks workable

No manufacturer sells direct on page 1. Protimeter ranks with content only; FLIR routes through dealers (Tester.co.uk appears via advice content). The open question is dealer margin economics against master distributors, which is a phone call, not a page-1 conflict. The pack's own diligence step (interview 12 surveyors, seek vertical-kit rights from 3 brands) is exactly right; we would add the £300 ad test alongside it.

Suggested next step, per both frameworks

In parallel: dealer-terms conversations with the FLIR and Protimeter channels (the pack's supplier gate, in writing), 12 surveyor interviews (the pack's demand check), and a £300 exact-match ad test on 'damp survey kit', 'building survey equipment kit' and 'thermal camera surveyor kit' phrasings against one bundle landing page (our shelf test in reverse). Total cost under £500, decision inside a month.

The reciprocal check: your gate applied to our shortlist

Fairness cuts both ways, so we ran the pack's supplier gate over the current top three from our own research stream:

Our idea	Supplier-gate result
Fire pit replacement bowls	PASSES. The metal spinners (Excell, Steel Spinnings, Tanfield) are trade fabricators with no consumer channel or visible ambition to build one. No conflict path.
Natural swimming pond kits	CONDITIONAL. Gordon Low sells liners direct to consumers, so the liner SKU alone carries conflict risk. The differentiation must be the assembled kit (liner + filtration + planting + plan) and written kit-pricing terms are needed before anything is built.
Garden putting green DIY kits	CONDITIONAL. Nomow and Namgrass run consumer turf channels, so raw-turf reselling would be undercut. Mitigation per your own rules: an own-brand kit SKU, a second turf source (TigerTurf), and the 60% protected-revenue threshold.

The merged method going forward

From the pack we adopt: supplier defensibility as a weighted hard gate, written price and parity terms before inventory, the unit-economics thresholds (35% landed margin, 15% contribution, 60% protected revenue), and the refusal to fabricate keyword data. From our stream we add: live page-1 checks before any idea is scored (desk-judged competition scores were the single failure point here), the mis-served-search test as the primary opportunity signal, the foreign-brand-on-UK-page-1 leading indicator, and a sub-£500 ad test before any build. One screen, run in that order: live shelf test, supplier gate, ad test.

Prepared August 2026 · Sabroso Studio research · Evidence: 19 live Google UK SERP pulls (August 2026) + Ahrefs GB keyword data; full detail in the companion spreadsheet's Live SERP Cross-Check and Keyword Validation tabs. Live SERPs change; re-verify before committing capital.